



HM Revenue
& Customs

Exports Declarant Guidance for Loaders using the Customs Declaration Service

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1. Purpose of this document

HMRC is moving processing of all customs declarations from its Customs Handling of Import and Export freight (CHIEF) system, to the [Customs Declaration Service \(CDS\)](#). From 4 June 2024, the CDS will be the UK's new single customs platform, providing a modern, secure IT platform supporting businesses to make import and export declarations into and out of the UK.

This document is designed for:

- **Both Air & Maritime customers** and is therefore applicable to customers regardless of the mode of transport they use to move their goods.
- **Loaders:** Airlines, Internal Temporary Storage Facilities (ITSF's), Carriers, and Designated Export Place (DEP) operators.

The document provides consolidated guidance on best practice for managing the movement of goods through the CDS. This document should be used alongside the existing more detailed [CDS guidance page](#) and the supporting CDS communication pack on GOV.UK, that includes:

- [Key differences between CHIEF and the CDS](#) – Highlights key ways in which your experience using CDS will differ from that with CHIEF.
- [CDS known error workarounds](#) – Please check this document for full technical details of ongoing workarounds to help you submit customs clearance requests or customs declarations through CDS.
- **The Exports Declarant Guidance for using the Customs Declaration Service** – the equivalent version of this product for Declarants (issued in its first iteration in early March). This will be a helpful reference point for understand issues which might have been created by incorrect upstream declarant behaviour in submitting or managing their declarations. Please ask your Community System Provider (CSP) or Software Provider for this pack if you don't have it.

Version Control

Version	Date	Updates made
V1	04/03/2024	Issuance of first iteration of document
V1.1	28/03/2024	• Section 2, Row 2: Added a row on an arrived UCR that has multiple movements. • Section 2, Row 11: Removed row on Apostrophes used in Transport ID field in movement messages as issue has now been resolved.

		• Section 2, Row 14: Added a row to include guidance on arrived DUCRs assigned SOE 22. • Section 2, Row 15: Added a row to include guidance on arrived DUCRs that have multiple movements assigned SOE 22. • Section 3, Row 16: Added a row to include guidance on submitting DUCRs to CDS Exports User Interface. • Section 4: Amended wording in Air environment section for further clarity. <i>*Please note in subsequent versions the above rows may have changed number*</i>
V1.2	16/5/24	• Section 2: Addition to header for clarification • Section 2, Row 1: Further clarification • Section 2, Row 15: Added a new row, row 15, on Missing ERS response following association or disassociation (EAC) of a CHIEF DUCR

2. Troubleshooting – common movement message issues and how to resolve them.

This section offers guidance on what to do in the instance of missing, incorrect, or unexpected UCR status updates (EMR/ERS messages).

Scenarios where re-arrival of a Master Unique Consignment Reference (MUCR) is required.

Sometimes, incorrect statuses may be returned by CDS following MUCR-level activity (consolidations or movements). In these instances, the MUCR must be re-arrived to elicit the correct, expected response. See the table below for a breakdown of scenarios where the MUCR must be re-arrived.

Please be aware that, on occasion, CDA may take longer to respond to arrival messages than would be desired due to performance issues during periods of peak load.

Whilst HMRC are working to further enhance system performance, you are advised to:

- **limit the number of re-arrivals to only 2,**
- **wait at least 30minutes** between each arrival attempt.

Failure to adhere to these guidelines will result in additional load on CDA and further delays to clearance of all shipments.

If, following the second arrival attempt, you have still not received any response, please refer to the guidance relating to the manual release process under Section 4 at the bottom of this document.

If the manual release process does not apply, please raise an issue with CDS following the guidelines under Section 5 of this document.

Table 1: Further detail on scenarios where actions might be required to resolve common movement message issues.

Scenario		Why has this happened?	What you need to do
1	I have arrived / re-arrived a Unique Consignment Reference (UCR) and I'm not getting a response.	On occasion, messages may not be returned due to known performance issues.	If you can, check your message logs to verify whether an EMR/ERS is missing. If a response is missing, arrange to re-arrive each movement against the UCR (once only) and having waited at least 30mins. If re-arrival does not elicit a response, contact the Software Provider or CSP for further assistance: • If there is an issue with the CDS, your Software Provide / CSP will raise an IT incident with HMRC.

Scenario		Why has this happened?	What you need to do
			If the shipment requires urgent clearance due to vessel / aircraft departure timings, manual release may be requested (maritime) / applied (air) as necessary – <i>See Manual Release instructions in section 4 of this document.</i>
2	I have arrived a MUCR and it's in an open status (SOE 0) even though it has been shut. <i>See appendix 7.2 for a full breakdown of SOE codes.</i>	On occasion, messages are not returned due to a known timings issue, so inventory statuses are not updated	Check the status of the MUCR on both CHIEF (using DCON) and the Inventory Linked Exports (ILE) query service. You can check the ILE query service using either: - CDS functionality provided by your software provider/CSP or, - the Exports Make and Manage an Export Declaration Service on GOV.UK. If the MUCR is present and closed in both CDS & CHIEF, arrange to re-arrive each movement against the MUCR individually, once only. If the MUCR is still open, contact the agent and ask for the MUCR to be shut, and for confirmation of action upon completion. Note the agent may advise they have closed the MUCR already. Once the agent confirms they have closed the MUCR, arrange to re-arrive each movement against the MUCR individually, once only.
3	I have arrived a UCR and it is showing route 3/6, no Permission To Progress (no P2P), any SOE other than 3. <i>See appendix 7.2 for a full breakdown of SOE codes.</i>	On occasion, messages are sent out of sequence. It is safe to re-arrive the MUCR if it is a Route 3/6 only.	Arrange to re-arrive each movement against the MUCR to elicit the correct status update.
4	I have arrived a MUCR and a new Declaration Unique Consignment	On occasion, messages are not returned due to a known timings issue.	If you are expecting a MUCR status update (EMR) and have not received one, arrange to re-arrive each movement

Scenario		Why has this happened?	What you need to do
	Reference (DUCR) has been associated to this MUCR, but I'm not receiving an update.		against the MUCR to elicit the latest status.
5	The status of an arrived MUCR has now changed to SOE E, even though it is not empty. <i>See appendix 7.2 for a full breakdown of SOE codes.</i>	This is because the MUCR contains both CHIEF and CDS DUCRs, but the CDS DUCR(s) have now been disassociated.	Arrange to re-arrive each movement against the MUCR to elicit the status of the now CHIEF-only MUCR.
6	I have now disassociated a held CHIEF DUCR from a shut MUCR, but the overall status of the MUCR is still showing held.	On occasion, messages are not returned due to a known timings issue meaning inventory statuses are not updated.	Arrange to re-arrive each movementTR against the MUCR to elicit the correct updated status.
7	I have arrived a UCR and received error code 27. <i>See appendix 7.1 for a full breakdown of error codes that can be received.</i>	This is because you do not have permission to send arrivals from the location linked to the goods location code you have used in the arrival message.	Contact HMRC using the report a problem when using the CDS G-Form on GOV.UK. If you hold an approval which includes the goods location code in question, HMRC will update the CDS to enable arrival at that location successfully.
8	I am a DEP operator and I have departed a UCR and received error code 27. <i>See appendix 7.1 for a full breakdown of error codes that can be received.</i>	This is because you do not have permission to send departure messages.	DEP operators at inland locations are not authorised to send departure messages.
9	I have arrived a UCR and have received error code 28. <i>See appendix 7.1 for a full</i>	This is because you have either used an invalid goods location code in the arrival message, or the code you are using may not	Check the CDS Tariff appendix 16 for the correct goods location code. If the goods location does not appear in the Tariff, report a problem when using the CDS on GOV.UK.

Scenario		Why has this happened?	What you need to do
	<i>breakdown of error codes that can be received.</i>	be available for use yet.	
10	I have arrived a CHIEF DUCR with an alphabetic character in the DUCR Part data item of the movement message and I'm not getting a response.	This is because the CDS cannot process an alphabetic character within this data item of any movement message.	Submit a new request omitting the CHIEF DUCR Part Check Letter within the "UCR part number" data item. You should now receive a response.
11	I have checked the status of a MUCR using ILE query service and it is showing that the MUCR has P2P (SOE 3) , but the inventory is showing a held status (SOE C) . <i>See appendix 7.2 for a full breakdown of SOE codes.</i>	This is because during exports dual running a MUCR can exist on both systems and therefore it is possible for it to be cleared in one system but held in the other.	Check the status of the MUCR on CHIEF (DCON) as it is likely to be held on CHIEF. Always check both ILE and CHIEF to ensure correct status of a MUCR as it may exist in both systems. You will need to arrange to re-arrive each movement against the MUCR to elicit the correct updated status.
12	I have checked the status of a MUCR using CHIEF and it is showing that the MUCR has P2P (SOE 7) , but the inventory is showing a held status (SOE C) . <i>See appendix 7.2 for a full breakdown of SOE codes.</i>	This is because during exports dual running a MUCR can exist on both systems and therefore it is possible for it to be cleared in one system but held in the other.	Check the status of the MUCR using ILE query as it is likely to be held on CDS. You can do this using either: a. CDS functionality provided by your software provider/CSP or, b. the Exports Make and Manage an Export Declaration Service on GOV.UK. Always check both ILE and CHIEF to ensure correct status of a MUCR as it may exist in both systems. You will need to arrange to re-arrive each movement against the MUCR to elicit the correct updated status.

Scenario		Why has this happened?	What you need to do
13	I have arrived a DUCR and the status returned is SOE 22/ departed.	This is because an arrived declaration has been submitted using data that auto-departs the declaration when cleared. Alternatively, a pre-lodged declaration with data that auto – departs the declaration when cleared has already arrived.	This shipment will require manual release – <i>See Manual Release instructions in section 4 of this document.</i> <i>**The manual release workaround will only apply for an interim period.</i>
14	I have arrived a DUCR that has multiple movements and the status returned for one or more movements is SOE 22 / Departed	This is because a pre-lodged declaration has been submitted using data that auto-departs the declaration when cleared.	This shipment will require manual release – <i>See Manual Release instructions in section 4 of this document.</i> <i>**The manual release workaround will only apply for an interim period.</i>
15	I am missing an ERS response following association or disassociation (EAC) of a CHIEF DUCR	CDA may not generate an ERS response to an EAC request if the relevant DUCR was originally arrived via an EAL that also quoted a Part number and/or CHIEF generated Check Letter e.g. 001A	Re-arrive the DUCR but this time removing the CHIEF generated Check Letter and/or Part number from your EAL request. An ERS should now be sent confirming the latest status of the DUCR.
For awareness: Workaround in place until known issue for the CDS Exports User Interface (on GOV.UK) is fixed			
16	When attempting to complete any transaction involving a DUCR that has more than once hyphen, an error is returned.	Currently the CDS exports User Interface is not accepting DUCRs with more than one hyphen, even though they are accepted by CDS and CHIEF. Therefore, your transaction will error and you will be asked to use a valid DUCR	Inform the declarant they need to invalidate the declaration and resubmit a new one with a new DUCR with no more than one hyphen.

3. Actions to take when a declaration has been rejected (error code 15 / declaration is cancelled/terminated)

Currently, the CDS does not automatically disassociate a cancelled or invalidated CDS DUCR that sits under a MUCR (where the MUCR is included in the declaration or the DUCR is subsequently associated to a MUCR). A change request has been raised to address this; until then, however, remedial action must be taken, per the table below.

Table 2: What to do when you get error code 15.

Scenario		Why has this happened?	What you need to do
1	I have received an error code 15 (declaration is cancelled / terminated) for a DUCR.	The CDS declaration was either rejected at pre-arrival stage or has been rejected upon arrival.	You can contact the agent (who will have received a DMSREJ) and advise them that their declaration DUCR has been rejected upon arrival and ask for them to take the appropriate action. If the agent advises that they will be correcting the declaration or submitting a new declaration using the same DUCR, wait to be told that the declaration has been submitted and arrange to re-arrive each movement against that DUCR. If, however, they intend to use a new DUCR, wait to be given the new DUCR reference and replace the old DUCR with the new one against each movement.
2	I have received an error code 15 (declaration is cancelled / terminated) for a MUCR.	One or more of the CDS declarations that sits within the MUCR were either rejected at pre-arrival stage or have been rejected upon arrival.	You can interrogate the MUCR using ILE query service to identify the offending DUCR (which will show SOE 5 or SOE 11) using either: • CDS functionality provided by your software provider/CSP or, • the Exports Movement Service on Gov.uk. You can contact the agent (who will have received a DMSREJ) and advise them which declaration(s) has been invalidated and ask for them to take the appropriate action. If the agent advises that they will be submitting a new declaration for the goods that are physically contained within the consolidation, do not manifest/load the consolidation. Wait for the agent to advise you that their revised declaration has been accepted and reassociated into the MUCR. Now arrange to re-arrive the MUCR to elicit the status update. <i>N.B. for air only: If the agent advises that they no longer intend to export the goods under this MUCR,</i>

			<i>wait for the physical removal of goods from consolidation before manifesting / loading.</i>
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4. Manual release process

There are some scenarios whereby you may need to request the manual release of goods from the inventory, due to an intermittent CDS issue which prevents an inventory update.

The table below includes steps to take to gain manual release.

Air (For authorised airlines / ITSFs only)

1. Interrogate both CHIEF & ILE to check the status of the MUCR.
2. Confirm P2P in one or both systems.
 - a. If either system is showing held status (ILE = SOE C, CHIEF = SOE 1), do not proceed further and wait for MUCR to be cleared.
 - b. If CHIEF is showing P2P (SOE 7) and CDS is showing Route 0, SOE E, this indicates that the MUCR only exists on CHIEF and therefore has overall P2P.
 - c. If CDS is showing P2P (SOE 3) and CHIEF is showing SOE 0, this indicates that the MUCR only exists on CDS and therefore has overall P2P.
3. Take screenshots and retain as evidence of P2P.
 - a. This step is necessary for HMRC audit purposes.
4. Manually release inventory using "Release by TSO" functionality.

Maritime

1. Carrier / Declarant requests manual release by NCH using the G-Form.
 - a. For further guidance on how to complete the "[report a problem when using the CDS](#)" form when requesting manual release, contact your CSP / Software Provider.

5. Raising a query or issue with CDS

For issues that require HMRC investigation, you can either [contact us using one of these channels](#), or [report a problem when using the CDS on GOV.UK](#).

For technical issues, you should also contact your CSP or Software Provider who can investigate the issue and will raise a technical query with HMRC if necessary.

6. Useful links and further reading

[CDS error codes](#)

[Using the Trader Dress Rehearsal service](#)

[CHIEF error codes](#)

[Imports and exports: general enquiries](#)

7. Appendix

7.1 CDS error scenarios

Scenario	Message Types						Error Code	Additional Error Information
	EAL	EAA	EDL	EAC	CST	QUE		
Invalid UCR Format, DUCR or MUCR	X	X	X	X	X	X	01	For EAC, the parent to be associated to must also be a MUCR otherwise format validation will fail
Client ID validation fails				X			02	
UCR is not at the top of its' consolidation			X				03	
Cannot consolidate the MUCR as it is not shut				X			04	
Immediate parent MUCR cannot already be within its same tree/consolidation				X			05	
Cannot find the consolidation				X	X		06	
Consolidation already shut					X		07	
UCR Type does not match UCR Format	X	X	X	X	X	X	08	
Declaration does not exist				X			10	
UCR is already associated to given MUCR				X			11	
No prior EAL can be found for the UCR at the location given on the EDL			X				13	
Not all declaration(s) have P2P			X				14	
Declaration is cancelled/terminated	X	X	X	X			15	
Unknown Declaration ID, DUCR or MUCR						X	16	When DUCR or MUCR is unknown in the query service
Consolidation has reached maximum number of levels/items within a level				X			17	
Goods Departure/Arrival Date/Time is invalid		X	X				18	

Scenario	Message Types						Error Code	Additional Error Information
	EAL	EAA	EDL	EAC	CST	QUE		
Cannot depart the MUCR from UK as MUCR is not Shut			X				19	
Message sent with a future date/time (greater than 25hours in the future)		X					20	
UCR is not for a MUCR					X		21	
UCR to be disassociated does not exist				X			22	
UCR to be disassociated is not already associated				X			23	
Location-Based Permission failed	X	X	X				27	
Goods Location is invalid	X						28	
MUCR has been departed				X			29	
UCR cannot be associated as it has been rejected upon arrival				X			30	DUCR cannot be associated because it is rejected upon arrival (SOE 11) or MUCR cannot be associated because it contains at least one declaration which has been rejected upon arrival.
UCR already has a successful retrospective arrival	X	X	X	X		X	31	
Submitter ID must match last EAL/CST submitter				X			35	If the parent MUCR is arrived or shut, the last submitter of the EAL or CST of the top MUCR can associate/disassociate a UCR to/from the consolidation.

7.2 CDS status of entry (SOE) codes

The below status codes will appear in CDS status notifications, and declaration queries. Note that error codes 13, 17, 19, 20, and 23 are not relevant to exports, hence not in the below view.

CDS Status	CDS Code	CDS Description	CHIEF equivalent SOE	Comments
Not Available NB For use during Exports Dual Running (EDR) only.	NA	Arrived at a different location to that pre-lodged or error detected by OGD system.	SOE E	
Declaration does not exist	0	The declaration does not exist.	SOE 0	
Declaration Validation	1	The declaration is currently within validation and is not yet accepted, registered, or rejected. This code will be received for any initial linking of the declaration to the consignment on the inventory.	SOE 1	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS.
Declaration Goods Release	2	This status will be received once the declaration has a positive customs position but either control or the debt is provisional. However, the goods can be released. This will be received as part of a Declaration Status Notification.	SOE 7	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS.
Declaration Clearance	3	This status will be received once the declaration has a positive customs position, and the control/debt is finalised. Most declarations will move to this status and skip release. This will be received as part of a Declaration Status Notification.	SOE 7	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS.
Declaration Invalidated (at trader's request)	4 (ICS 3)	This status will be received as part of a Declaration Status Notification once the decision has been taken to invalidate the declaration. The ICS code will distinguish between a trader-initiated cancellation and a seizure/destruction of goods cancellation. The declaration will be auto disassociated if it is contained within a MUCR.	SOE 9 (ICS 92)	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS. Declaration cancelled by HMRC. This is a final declaration status.

Declaration Invalidated	4 (no ICS)	This status will be received as part of a Declaration Status Notification once the decision has been taken to invalidate the declaration.	SOE 4 (no ICS)	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS. This is a final declaration status.
Declaration Invalidated (by customs due to major discrepancies)	4 (ICS 6)	This status will be received as part of a Declaration Status Notification once the decision has been taken to invalidate the declaration. The ICS code will distinguish between a trader-initiated cancellation and a seizure/destruction of goods cancellation. The declaration will be auto disassociated if it is contained within a MUCR.	SOE 9 (ICS code anything other than 92 or 93)	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS. Declaration terminated. This is a final declaration status.
Declaration Rejected	5	If the declaration is rejected, then a Declaration Status Notification will be received with this code. The declaration will not be auto disassociated if it is contained within a MUCR.	SOE R	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS. This is a final declaration status.
Declaration Handled Externally	6	This status will be received as part of a Declaration Status Notification once the decision has been taken to take the declaration off system. This will occur in exports when goods are stopped/seized at the Office of Exit (whether through another member state, or via a re-arrival within the UK). This can occur at any time following presentation of the goods for export and when the goods are on-hand. Actions may vary between formal detention of the consignment and possible seizure action by Customs. The declaration will be auto disassociated if it is contained within a MUCR.	SOE 9 (ICS 07)	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS. Declaration seized.

Subject to Customs approval of amendment, query, or cancellation request. N B for use during EDR only.	7	Subject to Customs approval of amendment, query, or cancellation request.	SOE 4	Cancellation requested by trader.
Advance Declaration Registration	8	The declaration has been successfully registered.	SOE 1	ROE H.
Declaration Acceptance	9	The declaration has now been legally accepted.	SOE 1	ROE H.
Declaration Acceptance at Goods Arrival	10	The declaration has successfully passed re-validation at the point of arrival.	SOE 1	Allocated ROE 1, 2, 3 or 6.
Declaration Rejection at Goods Arrival	11	If the declaration fails re-validation at the point of arrival, then this notification will be sent to CSPs. While the declaration is rejected, the DUCR will remain in a holding state, still associated to a consolidation if relevant. Traders are then expected to submit a new declaration with the DUCR from the rejected declaration. This will allow the consignment to progress through the inventory system. The declaration will not be auto disassociated if it is contained within a MUCR.	SOE R	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS. This is a final declaration status.
Declaration Corrected	12	The declaration has now been amended successfully including derived customs value.	SOE 1	Allocated ROE H, 1, 2, 3 or 6.
Declaration Risked	14	Notification that the declaration has now been risked and will contain a specific ROE code.	SOE 1	Declaration update triggers an EMR/ERS. Allocated ROE 1, 2, 3 or 6.
Customs Position Determined	15	The customs position on the declaration has now been determined following Risk and Case results. The declaration can now be cleared or seized as required.	SOE 1	Allocated ROE 1, 2, 3 or 6.

Declaration Clearance after Goods Release	16	Goods have now been cleared after release. For example, goods were previously released with only a non-blocking control task open; now the non-blocking control task has been closed.	SOE 7	
Declaration Received	18	The declaration has just been received and is in a stage prior to validation. The declaration is not yet accepted, registered, or rejected.	SOE 1	ROE H.
Goods Exit Results Received	21	A departure (indirect or direct) for the declaration has been attempted for the first time.	SOE 8	
Completed Successfully	22	The departure has been successful, and the declaration has completed.	SOE 8	
Manual Task Raised	24	A manual task has been raised that needs to be investigated to resolve an open control task.	SOE 1	
Departed	D	The declaration has been departed.	SOE 8	
Frustrated	F	The declaration has been frustrated (inland departure).	SOE D	
MUCR Values				
Consolidation is Open	0	The MUCR has been created and contains declaration but is still open.	SOE 0	
Consolidation but contains no declarations	0	The MUCR has been created but contains no declarations.	SOE E	
Consolidation is closed but does not have P2P	C	The consolidation is closed, but there are underlying declarations that do not have P2P.	SOE 1	
Consolidation has P2P	3	The consolidation is closed, and all underlying declarations have P2P or have departed.	SOE 7	